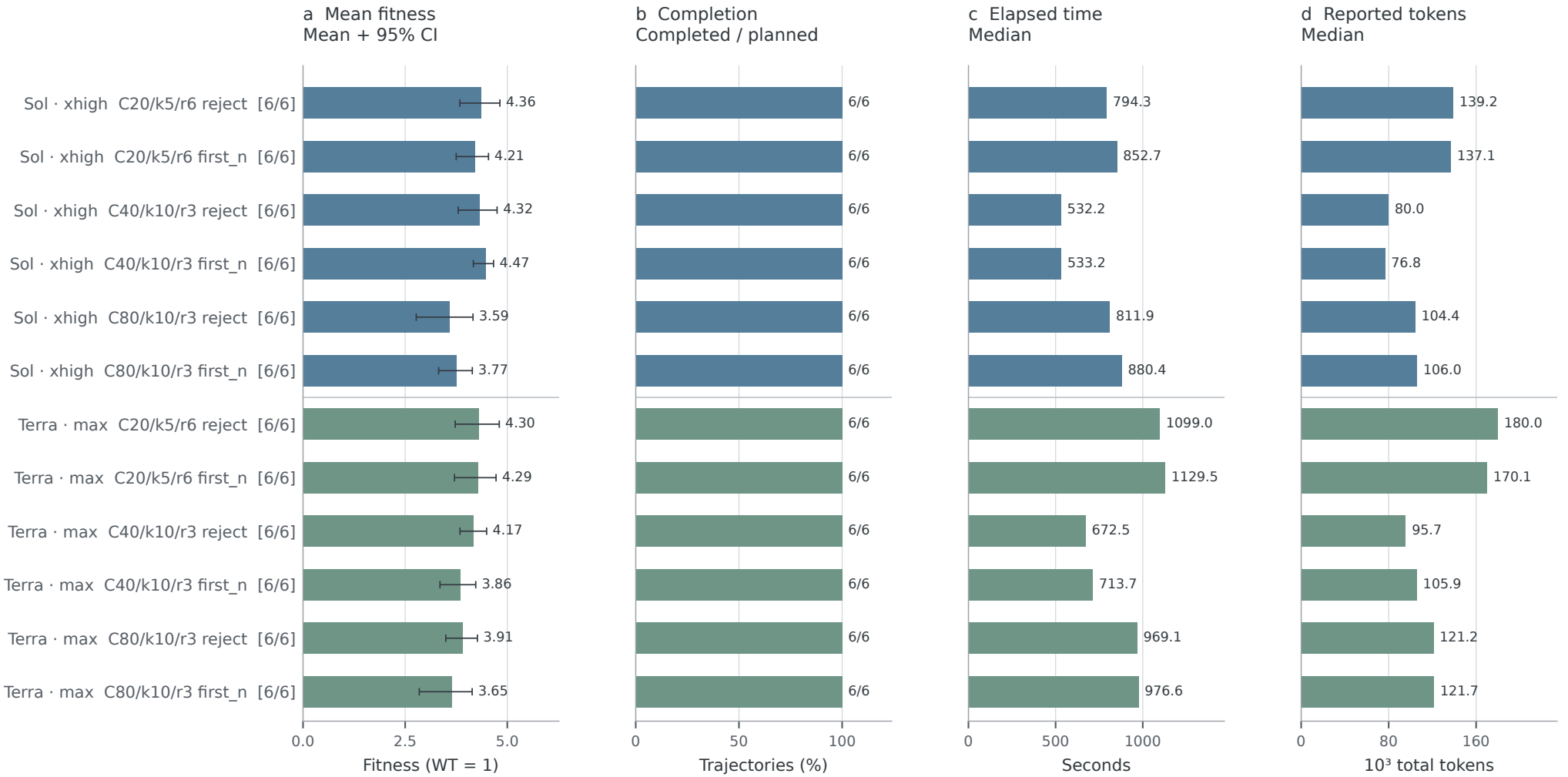
Candidate-budget configurations at a fixed 30-assay budget



Phase 2: 3 data splits × 2 independent trajectories per configuration. C = candidates/round; k = assays/round; r = rounds.

Sol: GPT-6.1 Sol / xhigh; Terra: GPT-6.1 Terra / max. All configurations query 30 variants. Labels: completed/planned.

Quality: equal-split mean with audited 95% hierarchical bootstrap CI. Cost: median of complete trajectories, excluding shared preparation.

reject: reject excess proposals; first_n: validate only the first C proposals in original response order.